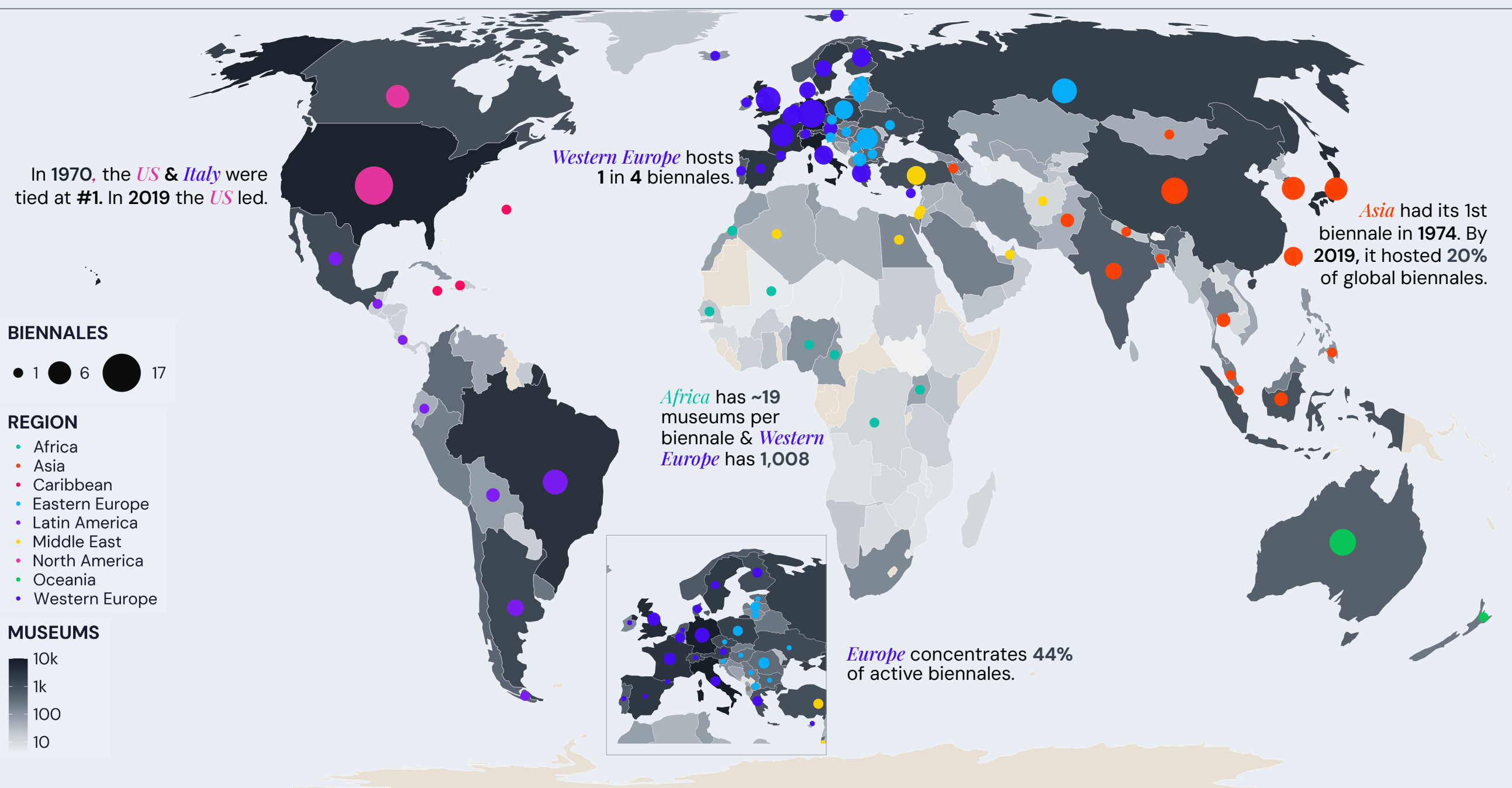


ART *follows* INFRASTRUCTURE

200 biennales in 2019. Art follows museums, not money.

Art biennales are recurring international exhibitions of contemporary art. Since Venice launched the first in 1895, they have become landmarks of the global art world.



Before 1990

36 biennales. Europe dominated.

1990 - 2004

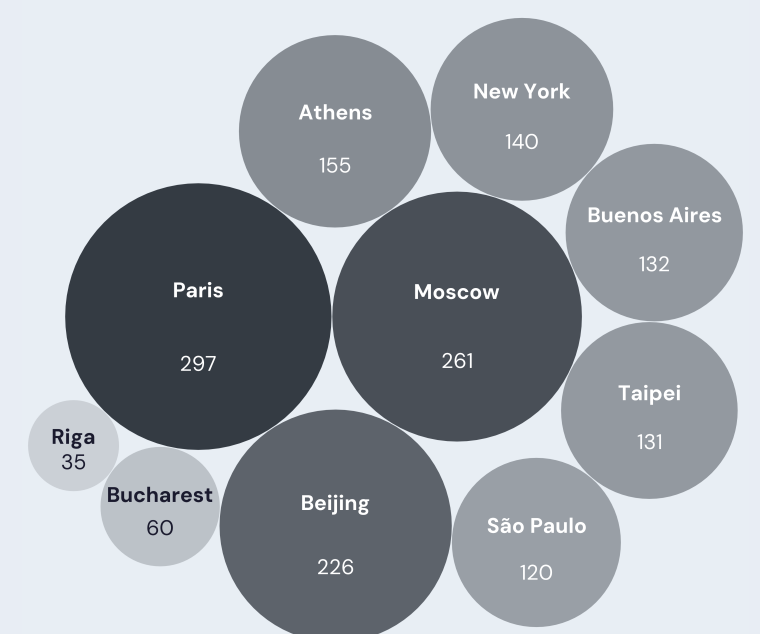
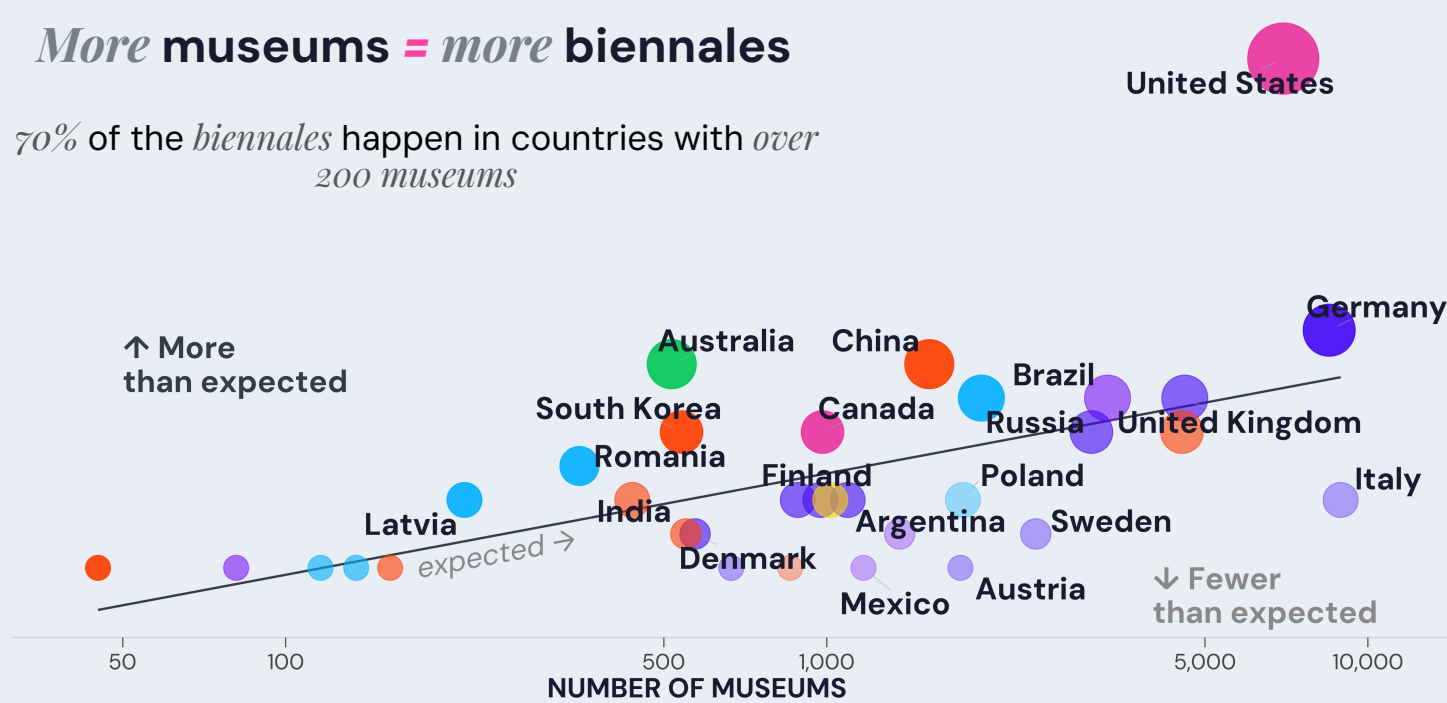
+ 50 events. Africa joins the map.

2005 - 2019

+ 112 all around the world. Asia ↑

More museums = more biennales

70% of the biennales happen in countries with over 200 museums



8 out of 10 cities with more biennales have more than 100 museums.

More spending ≠ more museums

The natural assumption is that public investment drives cultural activity. But this pattern suggests otherwise. Countries with more museums host more biennales, even when public cultural spending varies widely. Museum infrastructure appears more closely linked to where art gathers.

